

Academic Conjunctions Reference

Nidanur Günay — Master's Thesis Writing Aid

University of Konstanz, 2026

*Preferred conjunctions for this thesis are marked **bold**. Register levels: formal = strong academic register; neutral = safe everywhere; semi-formal = use sparingly.*

Addition

Conjunction	Register
furthermore	formal
moreover	formal
in addition	neutral
additionally	neutral
equally	formal
besides	semi-formal
also	neutral

Result & Consequence

Conjunction	Register
consequently	formal
therefore	formal
thus	formal
meaning that	semi-formal
hence	formal
accordingly	formal
as a result	neutral
for this reason	neutral

Contrast & Concession

Conjunction	Register
however	formal
nevertheless	formal
nonetheless	formal
by contrast	formal
conversely	formal
whereas	formal
yet	formal
on the other hand	neutral
that said	semi-formal
while	neutral
although / even though	neutral
despite / in spite of	formal

Cause & Reason

Conjunction	Register
since	formal
given that	formal
given	formal
as	formal
in view of	formal
on account of	formal
owing to	formal
due to	semi-formal
because	neutral

Condition

Conjunction	Register
provided that	formal
given that	formal
on condition that	formal
unless	neutral
as long as	neutral
if	neutral

Purpose

Conjunction	Register
in order to	formal
with the aim of	formal
so as to	formal
with the intention of	formal
to	neutral

Sequence & Time

Conjunction	Register
subsequently	formal
thereafter	formal
ultimately	formal
initially	formal
previously	formal
first / then / finally	neutral
eventually	neutral

Comparison

Conjunction	Register
similarly	formal
likewise	formal
by the same token	formal
in the same way	neutral
equally	formal

Example & Illustration

Conjunction	Register
in particular	formal
namely	formal
specifically	formal
to illustrate	formal
for instance	neutral
for example	neutral

Clarification

Conjunction	Register
more specifically	formal
to be precise	formal
namely	formal
in other words	neutral
that is	neutral

Summary & Conclusion

Conjunction	Register
taken together	formal
in summary	neutral
overall	neutral
in short	semi-formal
to conclude	neutral

Emphasis

Conjunction	Register
notably	formal
particularly	formal
above all	formal
indeed	formal
in fact	neutral
most importantly	neutral

Thesis-specific rules (CLAUDE.md):

- Prefer **since** / **given that** over *because* for causal clauses
- Prefer **consequently** / **meaning that** over *so* for results
- Use **however** to pivot to a limitation; use **furthermore** to add a supporting point
- Never use: *owing to the fact that, it is evident that, it should be noted that*
- **Due to** is semi-formal — prefer **given** or **since** where possible